

PICKLING



Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do you need to add vinegar with at least 5% acidity when making pickles?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To keep harmful bacteria from growing and spoiling the food

FUN FACT

Vinegar stops bad germs from growing when you pickle!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

What type of salt is best to use in making pickles at home?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Pickling or canning salt without additives

FUN FACT

*Using the right salt keeps your pickles
tasty and safe!*

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs



Q

When you watch a grown-up make sauerkraut or kimchi, why do they make sure the vegetables stay under the salty water?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To keep air away so bad molds and germs don't grow

FUN FACT

The salty water, called brine, helps keep the good stuff safe by blocking out yucky germs!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs



Q

What happens if you cut off the blossom end of cucumbers before pickling?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

It helps keep the pickles from getting soft or mushy

FUN FACT

That tiny blossom end has enzymes that can make pickles soft!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why should you never reduce the amount of vinegar in a pickling recipe?

PICKLING



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because less vinegar lowers acidity and can let harmful bacteria grow

FUN FACT

The acidity in vinegar is a pickle's best safety shield!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

What is the purpose of soaking cucumbers in a salt and ice water brine before pickling?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To draw out water so pickles stay crisp

FUN FACT

Ice helps cucumbers stay crunchy when pickled!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs



Q

What kind of container is safest to use for fermenting vegetables like sauerkraut?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

A food-grade crock or glass container

FUN FACT

Only special containers keep your ferment yummy and safe!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why is it important to add a weight to vegetables during fermentation?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To keep the vegetables under the brine, away from air

FUN FACT

Weights keep veggies underwater so good bacteria can grow!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs



Q

What happens if you reuse metal canning lids instead of using new ones?

PICKLING



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

The lids might not seal properly, risking spoiled pickles

FUN FACT

One-time-use lids help keep your pickles safe and fresh!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why should you avoid using zinc or copper utensils when pickling?

PICKLING



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

They can react with acid and ruin the pickle's color and safety

FUN FACT

Only use safe tools so your pickles stay tasty and pretty!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

What is a quick pickle?

PICKLING



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Pickles made fast by adding vinegar without fermentation

FUN FACT

Quick pickles are ready in just 1 or 2 days!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs



Q

How long do you usually need to store home-canned pickles before they develop the best flavor?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

About 4 to 5 weeks

FUN FACT

Great flavors need a little time to grow in the jar!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs



Q

Why do some pickle recipes call for cutting off just a little bit of the cucumber's stem end and leaving some stem attached?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To help keep the pickles firmer during processing

FUN FACT

A tiny stem helps cucumbers stay crisp in the jar!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

When a grown-up is making pickles, why do they make sure the vegetables stay underwater in the salty liquid called brine?

PICKLING



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because keeping the vegetables underwater stops mold and bad germs from growing on them.

FUN FACT

Keeping vegetables under the brine helps only the good tiny helpers grow, so the pickles taste yummy and safe!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

When watching a grown-up make pickles, why do they gently slide a tool inside the jar before sealing it?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To let out tiny air bubbles so the jar can seal properly and keep the pickles safe.

FUN FACT

Getting rid of air bubbles helps the jar seal tight, which keeps the pickles fresh and safe to eat!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs



Q

What kind of vegetables should you select for making pickles?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

**Fresh, tender vegetables
without blemishes or mold**

FUN FACT

*Fresh veggies make the best crunchy
pickles!*

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

If you see that pickles were stored with not enough vinegar, what might happen to them?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

They could go bad because some yucky germs might grow.

FUN FACT

Using enough vinegar when making pickles helps keep them safe and tasty to eat!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

When watching an adult make pickles, you might see them soak cucumber slices in a special lime water before making them. Why do you think they do this?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To help the cucumbers stay crisp and firm in the pickles.

FUN FACT

Soaking cucumbers in lime water helps them stay crunchy and delicious when they turn into pickles!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs



Q

Why should you not use rock salt or sea salt for pickling?

PICKLING



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

They have impurities that can spoil the pickles

FUN FACT

Pickling salt is pure and safe for preserving food!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

What is the role of sugar in sweet pickles?

PICKLING



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To balance vinegar's sharp taste and add sweetness

FUN FACT

Sugar makes sweet pickles tasty and delicious!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs